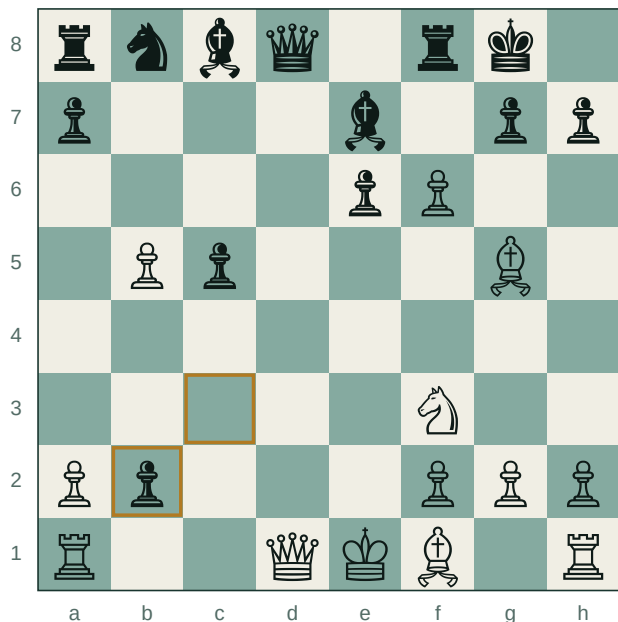


Advanced-pawn tactics: White, move 12

Advanced-pawn tactics

White to move



Previous move: 11...cxb2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

12. fxe7 Qxd1+ 13. Rxd1

12.fxe7 The pawn captures the bishop on e7. From e7 it attacks queen on d8 and rook on f8. Recorded reply: **12...Qxd1+.**

13.Rxd1 The rook captures the queen on d1.

At the end, nominal material is White 25 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8. Check for tactical protection.